JAMES MICHAEL RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Engineer with 12 years building and scaling distributed systems across fintech and cloud infrastructure domains. I've led architectural decisions that reduced system latency by 60% and mentored teams through complex migrations. I focus on solving problems that matter, whether that's improving deployment pipelines or helping junior engineers understand database internals. I'm based in Birmingham and enjoy working on challenges where the technical solution directly impacts business outcomes.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Quantix Technologies

www.quantix.io

Birmingham, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Architected microservices migration from monolithic Java application, reducing deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes and enabling independent team deployments.

Led platform reliability initiatives that improved system uptime from 99.5% to 99.97%, including implementation of distributed tracing and observability stack.

Mentored 6 junior and mid-level engineers through code reviews, design discussions, and knowledge sharing sessions on system design patterns.

Established engineering standards for API design, database schema changes, and incident response procedures adopted across 40-person engineering team.

Senior Software Engineer

CloudCore Solutions Ltd

www.cloudcore.co.uk

Birmingham, United Kingdom

August 2017 - February 2021

Designed and implemented containerised infrastructure supporting 50+ microservices deployed on Kubernetes, handling 2 million requests per second at peak load.

Reduced database query latency by 62% through implementation of caching strategies, query optimisation, and index refactoring on PostgreSQL clusters.

Owned on-call rotation for critical production systems and established blameless incident post-mortem process that improved mean time to resolution by 40%.

Developed automation tools in Python and Golang that reduced manual operational tasks by 25 hours per week across infrastructure team.

Software Engineer

Beacon Digital Ltd

www.beacondigital.net

Coventry, United Kingdom

June 2012 - July 2017

Built RESTful APIs in Java and Node.js serving internal and external customers, handling 100+ requests per second with 99.9% uptime SLA.

Implemented continuous integration pipeline using Jenkins and automated testing framework that increased code coverage from 45% to 78% within 18 months.

Migrated legacy payment processing system to event-driven architecture using Apache Kafka, enabling real-time transaction monitoring and reducing reconciliation time.

Collaborated with product and business teams to translate requirements into technical specifications and delivered features across full application stack.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL, JavaScript, TypeScript

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Linux

Messaging and Events: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis Pub/Sub

Tools and Platforms: Git, Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, Datadog, Prometheus, ELK Stack

System Design: Microservices architecture, distributed systems, event-driven design, database optimisation